



It may look pretty but it kills your laptop

OPTIMISING YOUR MOBILE DEVICE

It's extremely important to be able to manage your phone as well as your PC today. Optimising your mobile devices which are drowning in an smorgasbord of apps and functionalities will help you stay afloat in a tech-savvy world.



Skyfire with Facebook Connect for iPad

Try a different browser

Traditional stock browsers on your devices don't always give you the best of functionality. While you can surf the net with ease on the Android, it's a relatively bare-bones browser app. iOS has a good Safari browser as well. But you can experiment and find better browsers off the apps marketplace. A few popular ones in the alternate browser space include Dolphin, Firefox and Skyfire.

Make use of widgets

You'll find widgets on Android and Windows Phone devices. They give you a quick glance/preview of apps and provide an access point to your favourite apps. With the Facebook widget, you can get a quick view of status updates.



Widgets on Android

The clock widget on the Android platform lets you put an analog or digital clock along with various world times on your home screen. In Android to add a new widget, tap and hold on top of the home screen

and select the Widgets menu. A lot of apps have in-built widgets, but it's also possible for you to download more widgets from the Android Market. A very useful widget to check out is the 3G Watchdog, which gives you a summary of data usage on your home screen.

Make sure you have an anti-virus installed

In case you were thinking that viruses only infect computers, you couldn't be more wrong. Mobile devices (especially Android devices as they allow third-party installation of apps) can get easily infected through open Wi-Fi networks or apps. To better equip yourselves against malware, suspicious access and privacy intrusion, you can look for and install an anti-virus app after downloading it directly from the marketplace. A few examples for mobile anti-virus apps are Lookout and AVG. They're free,



AVG anti-virus for a mobile device

scan all your apps and back up your contacts.

Adjust vibration

Having a vibrator on the phone is always a heavy strain on the phone's battery but considering the fight for battery life by the processor and screen as well, it's necessary to save power wherever possible. Disabling vibration is not that simple in the iOS. To work with this feature, go to Settings > General > Accessibility. At the very bottom, you'll see an option to customise the vibration setting.

Notifications on the LED

The most important function of most mobile devices amidst all their functionalities is making a phone call. For iOS devices to be able to get a notification for messages or calls missed is very easy. Just go to Settings > General > Accessibility and select the LED flash for Alerts option.



Onavo app for Android



Notifications settings

Restrict access system

Make sure that only the features you use are running in the background and not any unnecessary apps like location-based services which use up a lot of battery. For an iOS device this feature can be accessed at Settings > Locations Services

Keep track of data and battery hogs

If you're not sure about the data or storage consumption of apps on your mobile device, information can be found on an iOS device from Settings > General > Usage and for Android devices you can use additional apps like Onavo.

PHOTOSHOP CS6 BETA

The grand ol' daddy image editing app is getting a whole new look and a host of cool new features in the next iteration. To get your hands dirty, grab the Beta version available on this Adobe Labs page: <http://labs.adobe.com/downloads/photoshopcs6.html> Here are a few tips to introduce you to some of the changes incorporated in this version of Photoshop.

User interface

The first thing that you'll notice when you open the redesigned Photoshop for the first time is the completely souped up and